

Antora Energy

Energy Storage · Thermal Batteries for Industry & Data Centres · Sunnyvale, California (factory in San Jose) · Private (\$550M Series C, Jul 2026; \$2.47B reported)

Antora, the Californian thermal-battery maker whose 5 GWh South Dakota system is one of the largest storage projects in the world, closed an oversubscribed \$550M Series C on 30 July 2026, co-led by G2 Venture Partners and Eclipse, to build a second US factory for industry and data centres.

71

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Andretti Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Antora announced on 30 July that it had closed \$550M of Series C funding, co-led by G2 Venture Partners and Eclipse, with Ribbit Capital, Salesforce Ventures, StepStone and John Doerr joining Breakthrough Energy Ventures, Lowercarbon and Decarbonization Partners. Total funding stands at \$770M; Crunchbase News reports a \$2.47B valuation, which the company has not stated. The money funds a second US manufacturing hub and large projects. The proof point landed in May: a 50 MW / 5 GWh thermal battery at POET's Big Stone City plant, built in under twelve months and now delivering energy. Bloomberg framed the raise around the data-centre boom: Antora stores cheap electricity as heat in solid carbon blocks and returns it around the clock as heat or power, the load-shifting story hyperscalers and utilities are buying. The company says it has signed agreements with hyperscale operators but has not named them. A brand that sells to industrial CFOs, utilities and data-centre developers now needs a national stage on which to say 'reindustrialise America' out loud.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 30 July; the second-factory site is the next announcement. Formula E's GEN4 era opens in Jeddah on 18 December, and Season 13 adds a new Austin E-Prix on 6 February 2027 with Miami a fortnight later: two US rounds in Antora's first year at scale.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$550M

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\$770M

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 10 OF 35 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Andretti Formula E	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Lola Yamaha ABT Formula E Team	TAKEN	Shell
Citroën Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Cupra Kiro	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A \$550M round closed on 30 July, one of the largest cleantech raises of the year, a 5 GWh proof plant running in South Dakota, and two US E-Prix in February: Antora has the budget, the story and the stage. Andretti's energy lane is open and its owner offers a path to F1.

FUNDING EVENT

US STAGE

CATEGORY OPEN

DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY ANDRETTI FORMULA E

Andretti Formula E is the American team on the grid, run from Indianapolis by TWG Motorsports, which also operates the Cadillac F1 team. Its roster is TWG AI, Quest Global, Crowe UK and Reflo, and the sponsor table shows no energy or storage brand: the lane is open. GEN4 brings Nissan powertrains, Jake Dennis and Felipe Drugovich. For Antora the audience matters more than the podium: industrial buyers, utilities and hyperscalers at Austin and Miami, on an American car.

VALUE TO ANDRETTI FORMULA E — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo, stated honestly: a 50 MW thermal battery has no place in a garage. The mechanics are commercial. Official Energy Storage Partner designation and sidepod placement; hospitality at Austin and Miami for utility, hyperscaler and industrial buyers and state policymakers; co-produced content setting stored heat against the team's race-day energy management; and a step-up path to F1 through the same owner as Antora scales.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Energy Storage Partner. **THREE YEARS**, Seasons 13-15 (2026/27 to 2028/29), covering the second-factory build and the first hyperscaler projects. Estimated \$1.5-2.5M a year. Scope: sidepod branding, Austin and Miami hospitality, engineering content, an industrial-customer programme through TWG Motorsports, and an option to step up to the Cadillac F1 team from 2028.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Andrew Ponec

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, ANTORA ENERGY · **VERIFIED**

Ponec co-founded Antora with Justin Briggs and David Bierman and fronts every raise; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Bierman, Co-Founder and Chief Commercial Officer; Briggs, Co-Founder and COO, who owns policy and communications; Rene Griemens, CFO. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the American stage.

“Andrew, you just raised \$550M to reindustrialise America. The American Formula E team races in Austin and Miami in February with an open energy lane, and its owner also runs the Cadillac F1 team. 25 minutes to see what the seat costs?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Round closed 30 Jul; GEN4 opener in December, Austin and Miami in February.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 \$550M raised, \$770M in total; capital is earmarked for factories.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 Electrification and US reindustrialisation; B2B industrial audience.	URGENCY 12 / 20 No listing or deadline; second-factory launch is the soft trigger.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE B: no trackside use; open lane, US rounds, owner path to F1.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

HALO, NOT WORKSTREAM Thermal batteries do not run a race car; the value is audience and brand, not engineering. **Counter:** Tie renewal to a pipeline metric: utility and hyperscaler meetings booked at Austin and Miami.

VALUATION IS REPORTED The \$2.47B valuation comes from Crunchbase News, not the company; the raise is earmarked for factories. **Counter:** Anchor on the confirmed \$550M and \$770M totals and price the entry under \$3M a year.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- <https://www.antora.com/company>
- [https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260730278399/en/Antora-Closes-\\$550-Million-in-Series-C-Funding-to-Meet-Surging-Energy-Demand-and-Reindustrialize-America](https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260730278399/en/Antora-Closes-$550-Million-in-Series-C-Funding-to-Meet-Surging-Energy-Demand-and-Reindustrialize-America)
- <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-30/battery-startup-raises-550-million-amid-boom-in-ai-data-centers>
- <https://news.crunchbase.com/clean-tech-and-energy/battery-storage-startup-antora-550m-series-c/>